analyse the data, weigh the costs and benefits of the move, and assess if demonetization was the appropriate policy intervention to tackle black money, corruption, counterfeiting and terrorism? What were the RBI's assumptions about money supply and velocity when it took the decision? Did he have any concerns regarding the implementation? Did he share these with the government? If so, was he overruled? And if he was, what could he have done under the circumstances?

Y.V. Reddy, in a candid interview,[63] was clear in what he would have done. He said that he would have told the Prime Minister that it was impossible to carry out demonetization and to effect the replacement of currency on such a massive scale. He said, 'First I would have tried to impress upon the government that it should withdraw only ₹1,000 notes so as to minimise the disruption. *If the government still wanted to go ahead* with removing 86 per cent of currency in circulation, *I would have conveyed my inability to execute it*.' Though he said he may not have resigned, he would definitely have gone on sick leave.

Could it be that Raghuram G. Rajan, confronted by the same issues, had decided to return to academia rather than continue for a second term as Governor? We will probably have to await his memoirs to know. In the meanwhile, it appeared that Urjit Patel had not lived up to the standards of his predecessors, nor sadly to those he had once set himself.

In a paper co-authored by Urjit Patel in 2012, on inflation in India and the role of the RBI in taming it, Patel had been scathingly critical of the then RBI Governor, saying: '…disquieting and obvious questions need to be raised on public policy grounds… The central bank head is pleading hopelessness or a form of muddled eclecticism,' and concluded by lamenting that 'answers have been scarce'.

The larger point the paper made was that policy issues need to be grounded in rigour, costs and benefits should be weighed carefully, and only then should specific policy interventions be devised. It also rightly